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Employer guide

Egypt's new Labour Law No. 14 of 2025

Everything an employer needs: contracts, working hours, leave, pay, discipline and ending employment, with article numbers and worked examples.

Article by article | Old vs new law | Worked examples | Checklists

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Law No. 14 of 2025 was issued on 3 May 2025, took effect on 1 September 2025 and repealed Law No. 12 of 2003. This guide sets out a private-sector employer's obligations as the law states them, with the article next to each rule, worked examples and a checklist at the end.

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01 Overview and what changed

Dates, scope, and a comparison with Law 12/2003

Issued	3 May 2025
In force	1 September 2025
Specialised labour courts	From 1 October 2025
Repeals	Law No. 12 of 2003
Does not cover	State employees and domestic workers (Issuing Article 1)

The law covers foreign employees in Egypt wherever their contracts are silent, and it does not reduce any rights or benefits workers already had before it took effect (Issuing Article 4).

The main changes for employers

Topic	Law 12/2003	Law 14/2025
Notice (indefinite contract)	2 months; 3 after 10 years	3 months for everyone (Art 156)
Resignation	In writing to the employer	Certified by the labour authority; reply within 10 days (Art 167)
Maternity leave	90 days, twice, after 10 months' service	4 months, 3 times, no service condition (Art 54)
Paternity leave	None	Day of birth, paid, 3 times (Art 128)
Casual leave	6 days	7 days (Art 128)
First year of service	Pro-rata after 6 months	15 days (Art 124)
Annual raise	7% of basic wage	At least 3% of the insured wage (Art 12)
Overtime	Prior approval	Notify within 7 days (Art 121)
Contract copies	3 copies	4 copies; electronic signature allowed (Arts 89, 99)
Childcare leave	Twice	3 times (Art 57)
Training fund levy	1% of net profit	0.25% of the minimum insured wage, for 30+ workers (Art 21)

Employer tip

The new law ended claims for the old 1% training-fund levy for past periods, unless the establishment itself asks to continue the case (Issuing Article 2).

02 Contracts and records

What the contract must contain and what you report

The employment contract (Art 89)

- In writing and in Arabic, in four copies: employer, employee, social insurance office and the labour authority.
- For a foreign employee it may also be in their language; the Arabic text prevails.
- It must state at least: start date, employer name and address, employee details, qualification and insurance number, the nature of the work, the wage, how and when it is paid, and all cash and in-kind benefits.

New work patterns (Arts 96 to 99)

The law recognises remote, part-time, flexible and job-sharing work, with the same rights, duties, social insurance and minimum wage. The relationship must be in a written paper or electronic contract, and the parties may agree the employee also works for others, provided business secrets are kept.

What you report to the labour authority

Obligation	Deadline	Article
Detailed statement of headcount, qualifications, jobs, ages, nationalities, gender and wages	Within 30 days of starting operations	36
Update of the statement, plus vacancies and abolished jobs	Every January	36
Posted schedule of hours and weekly rest, copy to the authority	Within 7 days of any change	122
Work and disciplinary bylaws (10+ workers)	Within 60 days	137
Notice of overtime and its reasons	Within 7 days	121

Employee file (Art 92)

A paper or electronic file for each employee holding the contract, pay history, leave, disciplinary actions, performance reports, social insurance proof and the pre-employment medical.

Foreign employees (Arts 70 and 71)

A foreign national may only work with a work permit from the Ministry and residence for work. The Minister sets the maximum share of foreign staff and the professions closed to them.

> **Watch out**
>
> Breaching the foreign-employment rules carries a fine of EGP 20,000 to 100,000 (Art 293).

03 Probation, working hours and overtime

Articles 90, 117 to 123 and 129

Probation	Up to 3 months, once only with the same employer (Art 90)
Working hours	8 actual hours a day or 48 a week, excluding meal and rest breaks (Art 117)
Breaks	At least one hour a day, never more than 5 hours in a row (Art 118)
Daily span	No more than 10 hours from start to finish (Art 119)
Weekly rest	24 full paid hours after at most 6 working days (Art 120)
Time on site	12 hours a day at most in all cases (Art 121)

Overtime pay (Art 121)

Case	Minimum pay
Daytime overtime hour	Hourly wage + 35%
Night overtime hour	Hourly wage + 70%
Work on the weekly rest day	An extra day's wage, plus a day off in the following week
Work on a public holiday (Art 129)	The day's wage plus twice that wage, or a substitute day at the employee's written request

Overtime no longer needs prior approval, but the labour authority must be told the reasons and duration within 7 days.

Worked example · Overtime in one week

1. The employee's normal hourly wage: EGP 100.
2. 4 daytime hours: 4 × (100 + 35%) = EGP 540.
3. 2 night hours: 2 × (100 + 70%) = EGP 340.

Total due: at least EGP 880

Worked example · Working a public holiday

1. The employee's daily wage: EGP 600.
2. The day's wage 600 + twice that wage 1,200.

Due: EGP 1,800, or a substitute day on written request

The hour limits do not apply to the employer's authorised agents, or to guards, cleaners and preparatory work; the Minister sets their limits and they still earn overtime (Art 123).

04 Leave

Articles 54 to 57 and 124 to 131

Leave type	Entitlement	Notes
Annual, first year	15 days	Pro-rata once 6 months are served (Art 124)
Annual from year two	21 days	Public holidays and weekly rest are not counted
Annual after 10 years or age 50	30 days	10 years with one or more employers
Employees with disabilities	45 days	Cannot be split or postponed
Hazardous or remote work	+ 7 days	As set by ministerial decision
Casual	7 days a year	Max 2 days at a time; deducted from annual leave (Art 128)
Father, day of birth	1 paid day	3 times in service; not deducted from annual (Art 128)
Exams	Actual exam days, paid	10 days' notice and proof of sitting (Art 126)
Hajj or Jerusalem pilgrimage	1 month, paid	Once, after 5 continuous years (Art 130)
Sick	As set by the medical authority	Pay replacement under Social Insurance Law 148/2019 (Art 131)
Maternity	4 months, paid	At least 45 days after birth; 3 times in service (Art 54)
Childcare	Up to 2 years, unpaid	Establishments of 50+; after 1 year; 3 times; 2 years apart (Art 57)

Annual leave rules (Art 125)

- The employer sets the dates; the employee cannot waive the leave.
- The employee must take at least 15 days a year, 6 of them in a row.
- Balances are settled or paid out at least every 3 years, and any balance is paid out when employment ends.
- If the employee refuses in writing to take leave on the set dates, they lose the right to be paid for it.

Maternity protection (Arts 54 to 58)

- A pregnant employee's day is cut by at least one hour from the sixth month, with no overtime.

- She cannot be dismissed during maternity leave, or after returning unless the employer proves a legitimate reason.
- Two nursing breaks of at least 30 minutes each for two years after birth, counted as working time.
- She may end the contract for marriage, pregnancy or childbirth by notice within 3 months, keeping her rights.

Employer tip

What social insurance pays for maternity and sick leave is deducted from the wage you owe, so you do not pay twice.

05 Pay and the annual raise

Articles 12, 53, 102, 108 and 111 to 113

Private-sector minimum wage	EGP 7,000 a month since 1 March 2025, set by the National Wages Council
Review	PM Decision 3165/2026 requires the Council to review it at least once a year
Periodic raise	At least 3% of the insured wage, a year after hiring or the last raise (Art 12)
Raise exemption	Only the National Wages Council, for economic hardship, deciding within 30 days (Arts 12, 102)
Pay timing	At least monthly for salaried staff, in cash or to a bank account (Art 108)
Final pay	Within 7 days of the employee's claim (Art 108)
Equal pay	Equal pay for work of equal value, in every element of pay (Art 53)
Loan deductions	No more than 10% of pay, with no interest (Art 113)

Worked example · The annual raise

1. The employee's insured wage: EGP 10,000.
2. Minimum raise 3% = EGP 300 a month.

Due one year after hiring or the last raise

If the employee turns up ready to work and the employer prevents it, full pay is due; if a force-majeure reason outside the employer's control prevents it, half pay is due (Art 111).

Watch out

Late wages or breaching National Wages Council decisions carries a fine of EGP 2,000 to 20,000, multiplied by the number of workers (Art 287).

06 Discipline and workplace bylaws

Articles 137 to 148

Every establishment with 10 or more workers must prepare work and disciplinary bylaws covering promotion, transfer, pay, violations and penalties within 60 days, and file them with the labour authority for approval (Art 137).

Permitted penalties (Art 139)

- Written warning.
- Deduction from basic pay.
- Deferring the annual raise up to 3 months, or withholding up to half of it.
- Deferring promotion up to a year, cutting pay by one raise, or moving one grade down without a pay cut.
- Dismissal, which only the labour court can impose (Art 148).

No penalty may be imposed more than 30 days after the investigation ends, and the act must relate to the work (Art 138). A site manager may only issue warnings and deductions of up to 3 days (Art 148).

Gross misconduct that can justify dismissal (Art 148)

- False identity or forged documents.
- An error causing serious loss, reported to the authorities within 24 hours.
- Repeatedly breaking written, posted safety rules despite written warnings.
- Disclosing business secrets causing serious harm.
- Competing with the employer's business.
- Being visibly drunk or under the influence of drugs at work.
- Assaulting the employer or general manager, or a serious assault on a superior.

Employer tip

If the court finds for the employee in a dismissal case, it orders the employer to pay wages from the dismissal date, up to 6 months, by final decision (Art 150). Document the investigation and warnings before any step.

07 Ending employment

Articles 154 to 172

Situation	Rule	Art
Fixed-term contract	Ends at expiry. If over 5 years and the employer ends it after that: one month's pay per year of service	154
Indefinite contract	3 months' written notice from either side; cannot be shortened or waived by agreement, may be lengthened	156, 161
Reason needed	An indefinite contract may only end for a legitimate and sufficient reason	157
No notice given	The employer pays wages for the notice period or what remains; it counts as service	164
Unlawful termination	Compensation of at least two months' pay per year of service, plus other rights	165
Resignation	In writing, certified by the labour authority; the employer decides within 10 days or it is deemed accepted; the employee may withdraw within 10 days of being told it was accepted	167
Absence	Deemed resignation after 20 non-consecutive or 10 consecutive unexcused days, after a registered-letter warning at 10 or 5 days	166
Employer breach	The employee may resign; treated as unlawful termination by the employer	168
Death	Two months' pay for funeral costs (min EGP 1,000), plus a grant of the month of death and the next two	169
Age 60	Retirement age cannot be below 60; the employer may end the contract at 60 unless a fixed term runs beyond it	171

Reasons the law treats as unlawful (Art 165)

- Union membership or activity, or acting as a worker representative.
- Filing a complaint or claim against the employer.
- The employee using their leave rights.
- Colour, sex, marital status, family responsibilities, pregnancy, religion or political opinion.

During the notice period

- Notice cannot be given during leave, and pauses during sick leave (Art 159).
- The contract and all its obligations continue until notice ends (Art 160).
- If the employer gave notice, the employee may take one paid day or 8 hours a week to look for work (Art 162).
- The employee may be released from work during notice, on full pay (Art 163).

Worked example · Unlawful termination without notice

1. An employee with 5 years' service on EGP 20,000 a month.
2. Unlawful-termination compensation: 2 × 20,000 × 5 = at least EGP 200,000 (Art 165).
3. Pay in lieu of notice: 3 × 20,000 = EGP 60,000 (Art 164).

Minimum cost: EGP 260,000, plus leave balance and other dues

After age 60, if the employee has no old-age insurance rights for the period worked after 60, they earn an award: half a month per year for the first five years and a month per year after, on the last wage (Art 172).

08 Workplace and penalties

Harassment protection and fines

The law criminalises harassment, bullying and any verbal, physical or psychological violence against workers, by traditional or digital means, and requires a safe workplace. The employer may require drug and infectious-disease tests at its own cost (Art 135).

Breach	Fine	Art
Working hours, breaks, leave and equal treatment	EGP 500 to 5,000 per worker	288
Wages and National Wages Council decisions	EGP 2,000 to 20,000 per worker	287
Worker data and registration	EGP 1,000 to 20,000 per worker	286
Employing foreign nationals	EGP 20,000 to 100,000	293
Occupational health and safety	EGP 5,000 to 100,000	296

Watch out

The person actually managing the establishment faces the same penalties as the employer if they knew of the breach and their failure contributed; the company is jointly liable for fines.

09 Checklist and compliance calendar

What to review now, and when

- [ ] Contracts: Arabic, 4 copies, every item required by Art 89.
- [ ] Probation: 3 months maximum, once only.
- [ ] Notice in contracts and policies: 3 months.
- [ ] Leave policy: 15/21/30/45 days, 7 casual days, the father's day of birth.
- [ ] Maternity 4 months, reduced hours in pregnancy, two nursing breaks.
- [ ] Annual raise of at least 3% of insured wage on each employee's due date.
- [ ] Minimum wage EGP 7,000 for the private sector.
- [ ] Approved work and disciplinary bylaws (10+ workers).
- [ ] Complete paper or electronic employee files.
- [ ] Hours schedule posted, with a copy at the labour authority.
- [ ] Valid work permits for every foreign employee.

When	What to do
Every January	Update the headcount, wage and vacancy statement (Art 36)
Monthly	Pay wages, social insurance contributions and payroll tax
Within 7 days	Report overtime and any change to the hours schedule (Arts 121, 122)
Each hiring anniversary	Pay the periodic raise (Art 12)
At least every 3 years	Settle leave balances (Art 125)
July and January	Half-yearly injury and illness return for 30+ workers (Art 260)

Are your contracts and bylaws aligned with the new law?

In a free 30-minute check, a Talent360 consultant reviews your contracts, bylaws and social insurance set-up and gives you three written priorities.

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General guidance based on the text of Law 14/2025 and published 2026 decisions.